

and our peer group are set out hereunder:

Notes:

(i) All the financial information for the Company mentioned above is based on the Restated Financial information, for the financial year ended March 31, 2026.

(ii) All the financial information for listed industry peer mentioned above is sourced from the audited financial statements of the relevant company for Fiscal 2026

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement.
2. The Promoters or members of the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of Draft Red Herring Prospectus till date.



Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):		Bid / Offer Programme:	
Bid/ Offer Period (except the Bid/ Offer Closing Date)		Event	Indicative Date
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. Indian Standard Time ("IST")	Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Thursday, September 10, 2026
Bid/ Offer Closing Date*		Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unlocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Friday, September 11, 2026
Submission of Electronic Applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIBs, other than QIBs and NILs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST	Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Friday, September 11, 2026
Submission of Electronic Applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like Internet Banking, Mobile Banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is upto ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST	Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Tuesday, September 15, 2026
Submission of Electronic Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST	<i>* In case of any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI/ICDR Master Circular in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to unblocking/ unblocking of funds, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.</i>	
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST		
Submission of Physical Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST		
Modification/ Revision/cancellation of Bids		On the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until: (i) 4.00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders, and (ii) until 5.00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchanges, in case of Bids by RIBs. On Bid/Offer Closing Date, extension of time may be granted by Stock Exchanges only for uploading Bids received RIBs, after taking into account the total number of Bids received and as reported by the BRLMs to the Stock Exchanges.	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories ^a	Only between 10.00 a.m. on Bid/Offer Opening Date and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Offer Closing Date		
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date		
^a UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 05:00 p.m. on Bid/ Offer Closing Date. ^b QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids.			
Bid / Offer Programme:			
BID/OFFER OPENS ON	MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 07, 2026 ⁽¹⁾		
BID/OFFER CLOSES ON	WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 09, 2026 ^{(2),(3)}		
(1) Our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may consider participation by Anchor Investors. (2) Our Company may consider closing the Bid/Offer Period for QIBs one day prior to the Bid/Offer Closing Date in accordance with the SEBI/ICDR Regulations (3) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm IST on Bid/ Offer Closing Date, i.e. Wednesday, September 09, 2026			

ASBA* | Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

 UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, CBDT Circular No. 3 of 2023 dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Category; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section "**Offer Procedure**" on page 416 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIIB**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmid=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

Mandatory in public issues.
No cheque will be accepted.

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision of the Price Band subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding a total of 10 Working Days. In case of force majeure, banking strike or similar circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/Offer Period for a minimum of One Working Day, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, will be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the Book Running Lead Managers and at the terminals of the other members of the Syndicate and by intimation to the other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable.

Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes notification dated February 13, 2020 and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021, September 17, 2021 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this 2023-24 financial year.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as Regards its Objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see “**History and Certain Corporate Matters - Main objects of our Company**” on page 240 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for investors to read and understand the business of our Company and the risks involved in investing in our Company.

is an Offer in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, as amended ("SCRR"), read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in terms of Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein in terms of Regulation 32(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, not more than 40% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("QIBs") and such portion, the "QIB Portion") provided that our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("Anchor Investor Portion"). 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved for (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, as applicable, at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds at or above the price at which allotment is made to the Anchor Investor ("Anchor Investor Allocation Price"). In the event of under-subscription in (ii) above, the allocation may be made to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the Net QIB Portion. Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIB Bidders (other than Anchor Investors) including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. Further, not less than 15% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders out of which (a) one-third of such portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹20 million and up to ₹1.00 million; and (b) two-third of such portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹1.00 million, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to applicants in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Bidders subject to valid bids being received at or above the Offer Price and not less than 45% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("RIBs") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are required to mandatorily utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") process by providing details of their respective bank accounts (including UPI ID for UPI Bidders using UPI Mechanism) (as defined hereinafter) in which the Bid amount will be blocked by the SCSBs or the Sponsor Banks, as applicable, to participate in the Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see "Offer Procedure" on page 416 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bidder/Applicant Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available in the Depository database. (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS		REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
 Centrum Broking Limited (as successor to the merchant banking business of Centrum Capital Limited) Level 9, Centrum House, C.S.T. Road, Vidyanageri Marg Kalina, Santacruz (East), Mumbai – 400 098 Maharashtra, India. Telephone: +91 22 4215 9000; E-mail: pcpl ipo@centrum.co.in Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.grievances@centrum.co.in Website: www.centrumbroking.com Contact Person: Sooraj Bhatia / Tarun Parmani SEBI Registration No.: INM000013420		 KFin Technologies Limited Selenium Tower B, Plot No. 31 and 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally Hyderabad-500 032, Telangana, India Telephone: +91 6716 2222/18003094001 E-mail: pcpl ipo@kfinitech.com Investor Grievance e-mail: einward.ris@kfinitech.com Website: www.kfinitech.com Contact Person: M Murali Krishna SEBI Registration No.: INM0000011617	Ritu Jain PRANAV CONSTRUCTIONS LIMITED Unit No. 1001, 10th Floor, DLH Park Near MTNL, S.V. Road, Goregaon (West), Mumbai – 400 104 Telephone: +91 22 6276 9939 E-mail: compliance.officer@pranavconstructions.com Website: www.pranavconstructions.com Investors may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the **“Risk Factors”** beginning on page 18 of the RHP before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP will be made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and is available on the websites of the BRLMs, Centrum Broking Limited (as successor to the merchant banking business of Centrum Capital Limited) at www.centrumsbroking.com and PNB Investment Services Limited at www.pnbis.com and at the website of the Company, Pranav Constructions Limited at www.pranavconstructions.com and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and for National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at: www.pranavconstructions.com, www.centrumbroking.com, www.pnbis.com and www.kfintech.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORM: Bid cum Application Form can be obtained from the Registered Office of our Company, **PRANAV CONSTRUCTIONS LIMITED**.
Telephone: +91 22 6276 9939, **BRLMS:** Centrum Broking Limited (as successor to the merchant banking business of Centrum Capital Limited), Telephone: +91 22 4215 9000; PNB Investment Services Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6917 4200 and **Syndicate Members:** Centrum Broking Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4215 9000, Registered Brokers, SCSEBs. Designated RTA Locations and Designated CDP Locations for participating in the Offer, Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and at all the Designated Branches of SCSEBs, the list of which is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

SUB-SYNDICATE MEMBERS: Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Axis Capital Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Markets Limited.

PRANAV CONSTRUCTIONS LIMITED is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offer of its Equity Shares of ₹10 each (the "Offer") to the public. The Offer is being made pursuant to the prospectus (the "Prospectus") available at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the BRLMs i.e., Centrum Broking Limited (as successor to the merchant banking business of Centrum Capital Public Offer) at www.centrumbroking.com and www.pranavconstructions.com. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risks, please refer to the Prospectus. The Offer is being made by the Company and the Offer is being made by the Company and the Offer is being made by the Company.

The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been, and will not be, registered under the U.S. Securities Act and may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to being offered and sold only outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act ("**Regulation S**") and the app

as available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges.

(iii) The industry P/E ratio mentioned above is for the Financial Year ended March 31, 2026. P/E ratio has been computed based on the closing market price of equity shares on NSE/BSE on July 23, 2026, divided by the Diluted EPS for the year ended March 31, 2026.

(iv) For listed peers, Net Asset Value (NAV) is computed as equity attributable to owners (total equity) divided by the number of equity shares outstanding as on March 31, 2026.

(v) For listed peers, Return on Net Worth for equity shareholders (RONW) (%) = Profit for the year divided by total average equity.

(vi) EBITDA is calculated as PBT+ Interest+ Depreciation and Amortizations+ Finance cost.

14. Weighted average cost of acquisition compared to Floor Price and Cap Price:

Note: As certified by Agrawal Jain & Gupta, Chartered Accountants, Independent Chartered Accountants pursuant to their certificate dated September 01, 2026.

15. The Price/Earning ("P/E") ratio based on diluted EPS for latest full financial year 2026 for the issuer at the upper end of the Price band is as high as 15.16 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 113.46.

16. The average cost of acquisition of equity shares for the Investor Selling Shareholder in IPO is ₹42.55 and offer price at the upper end of the price band is ₹124.

17. The BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 7 public issues in the past 3 years out of which 3 issues closed below the issue price on listing date.

Name of the BRLMs	Total Issues	Issues Closed below Offer Price
Centrum Broking Limited (<i>as successor to the merchant banking business of Centrum Capital Limited</i>)	4	3
PNB Investment Services Limited	3	0
Total	7	3

SECURITIES OFFERINGS, BUT ARE BASED ON THE OFFERS OF THE U.S. SECURITIES THAT ARE APPROXIMATELY EQUIVALENT SECURITIES. THE EQUITY OFFERS IN THE OTHER AVAILABLE LAWS OF THE JURISDICTION WHERE THOSE OFFERS AND SALES OCCUR.

CONCEPT

the hindu businessline



IN FOCUS

	Week's close	Week's change
Nifty 50	23897.70	-277.95
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.27	-0.20
US Dollar (in ₹)	94.48	-0.89
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	154264.00	-4675
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	235456.00	-8436

NEW DIRECTION.

Tata Sons chief N Chandrasekaran will address Air India staff on Monday to welcome CEO-designate **p2**



BRANDLINE.

From liquor counters to Instagram checkouts, brands are turning risqué positioning into products **p8**

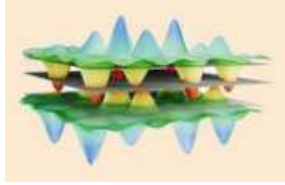
BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

MONDAY SPECIALS.

QUANTUM

A crystal that defies thermoelectric rules



Researchers from JNCASR, IISc and the University of Sydney have reported a record Seebeck coefficient in scandium nitride, challenging long-held limits for crystalline solids. This holds promise for a range of industrial uses, including ultrasensitive thermal and photon sensors. **p9**

LOGISTICS

Logistics firms brace for festival runs

Beginning with Onam in August and up to Pongal in January, India's festival calendar is turning into an extended peak season for the logistics industry, with the e-commerce, organised retail, consumer electronics, fashion and consumer durables segments expected to push cargo and express volumes higher. What's different this year is not merely the quantum of demand. **p10**

FCNR(B) deluge softens CD rates; large banks stay away

FUNDING PUSH. Sub-6% certificate of deposit rates to keep mid & small lenders active

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

Certificate of deposit (CD) rates have slipped below 6 per cent from the 7-7.25 per cent levels seen about three months ago, primarily due to the flood of liquidity generated by banks swapping Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) or FCNR(B) deposits with the Reserve Bank of India under its special concessional forex swap scheme.

The sharp decline in funding costs highlights the impact of the RBI's FCNR(B) window. By swapping \$127.23 billion of FCNR(B) deposits with the RBI, banks drew substantial rupee liquidity, curbing their need for CD funding.

LIQUIDITY IMPACT

The liquidity impact has been the most pronounced among large banks, which were the principal beneficiaries of the FCNR(B) scheme. Armed with fresh three-to-five-year FCNR(B) deposits and access to the RBI's concessional swap facility, these lenders have

EASING RATES

- FCNR(B) inflows drag CD rates below 6% as banks raise \$127.23 billion
- CD rates have fallen from 7-7.5% since June 8
- Mid and small lenders seek to benefit from lower wholesale funding costs
- Liquidity surplus of ₹10.31 lakh crore keeps rates soft



little incentive to access the CD market for near-term funding requirements.

"The excess liquidity is creating an interesting situation in the money market, with large banks not needing to raise much money and, at the same time, investors are sitting on large amounts of liquidity, looking for avenues to deploy it," said Venkatakrishnan Srinivasan, Founder and Managing Partner, Rockfort Fincap LLP.

He said the impact is clearly visible in market rates, with three-month CDs of top-rated banks trading as low as 5.8 per cent compared with levels above 7 per cent earlier. "Banks which don't need the money simply don't

come to the market, while banks which need to refinance or raise short-term funds are able to borrow at much cheaper rates as there is so much liquidity chasing bank paper. For larger banks, this is a good opportunity to refinance existing CDs and other relatively expensive short-term borrowings," he added.

KEY ISSUERS

In contrast, mid-size and smaller banks are expected to emerge as key issuers in the CD market in the coming months. Unlike their larger peers, many of them were unable to garner substantial FCNR(B) inflows because they lacked the balance-

Ahead of listing, NSE revives 'permitted to trade' universe with 250 securities

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) has significantly expanded its "permitted to trade" universe this year, adding 250 securities to a segment that had seen little activity in recent years.

The expansion comes at a time when the NSE is moving closer to its long-awaited listing and considering whether its own shares could eventually trade on its platform.

The NSE added 106 securities with effect from April 20 and another 144 from August 17. The last addition to the category was in 2022. The BSE currently has 30 companies under its permitted-to-trade (PTT) category.

TRADING FRENZY

The first batch has already seen a sharp increase in trading activity, with average daily turnover rising from about ₹92 crore on the BSE to around ₹400 crore across the NSE and the BSE after the securities became available for trading on both exchanges.

The jump in volumes shows the potential liquidity benefit of allowing a security listed on one exchange to



106 of the 250 securities saw a four-fold jump in turnover after admission to the NSE

trade on another. Under the NSE's PTT framework, securities can trade on the NSE without being formally listed there, while their primary listing and existing compliance obligations remain with the original exchange.

PTT FRAMEWORK

The framework, however, is not directly applicable to a stock exchange seeking to trade its own shares. The NSE has approached the market regulator on whether its shares could be admitted for trading on the NSE under the PTT route after being formally listed on the BSE.

Two weeks ago, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said the regulator was yet to decide on the matter and that it would require a detailed assessment. Last

Friday, SEBI gave the NSE final approval to proceed with its listing, which is expected by September 25.

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

While PTT allows securities to trade on the NSE without listing, companies need to meet the NSE's eligibility criteria for a direct listing. Of the 250 securities added, only 25 appear to meet the exchange's existing direct-listing criteria.

Around 110 companies do not meet the ₹10 crore paid-up capital requirement, while 234 do not meet the revenue criterion and 47 do not meet the positive-EBITDA criterion. On market capitalisation, 214 companies were found ineligible.

Meanwhile, the trading activity of the scrip is subject to all surveillance measures like any other listed scrip. As many as 127 of the 250 securities have been subject to measures such as the Additional Surveillance Measure (ASM) or Graded Surveillance Measure (GSM).

The expansion of the PTT universe and the liquidity it has generated come when the NSE is seeking permission to trade its own shares on the platform, potentially strengthening the case for the proposed arrangement.

Strong prices expected for most kharif crops

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

With the kharif crops set to arrive in the mandis in about 10 days, farmers in top-producing States are expected to receive favourable market prices. The only notable concerns are bajra (pear millet) and moong (green gram), which are lagging behind at 31 per cent and 13 per cent below their MSPs.

Nine out of 14 kharif crops for which MSPs have been announced, including maize, jowar, tur, urad and soybean, were sold on average either at par with their respective MSP (of the 2026-27 season) or higher on September 4, according to Agmarknet data.

In the case of paddy, the key kharif crop in which market rates are influenced by government procurement, currently the average price in Uttar Pradesh is ₹1,965/quintal, the data show.

Despite reports of some

Mandi prices ahead of kharif crops arrival (₹/quintal)

	Avg price**	MSP*	% change
Maize	2,684	2,410	11.4
Jowar	4,381	4,023	8.9
Tur	8,475	8,450	0.3
Urad	8,210	8,200	0.1
Soybean	5,674	5,708	-0.6
Groundnut	6,900*	7,517	-8.2
Moong	7,662	8,780	-12.7
Paddy	1,965	2,461	-20.2
Bajra	1,998	2,900	-31.1

*For 2026-27 season; ** in top-producing State on Sept 4, 2026; *in Rajasthan



likely productivity losses due to the impact of El Nino, the mandi prices of bajra, paddy, moong, groundnut and soybean are ruling in negative, ranging from 0.6 per cent to 31 per cent over their next season's MSP. Maize, jowar, tur and urad are over their MSP by up to 11 per cent.

HIGHER PRICES

"There is no problem with paddy as the government has been procuring 40 per cent of production. Once the purchase starts (which varies

from State to State), mandi prices, too, pick up. This time, soybean prices are higher compared to last year, despite strong import of its oil. The groundnut crop in Gujarat also looks good this year and its prices are also expected to move up," said a former Additional Secretary in the Agriculture Ministry.

Maize price, which is ruling higher, is likely to fall once the crop arrives as its demand will compete with other animal feed like soy-meal and DDGS, he added.

"Going by the historical data and El Nino impact in the previous years, there seems to be definite production loss this season. The market is already sensitive to it, which is factored in present prices. The sudden drop in soybean is surprising, which should not hold for long as cartelisation seems to be the reason for it," said SK Singh, a former additional MD of Nafed.

Overall, major crops should see prices aligned with their MSP for their FAQ grade, except moong where stock disposal by government agencies may keep prices below MSP, he added.

In the current year, the sowing area under maize is lower by 3 per cent at 91 lakh hectares (lh) from the year-ago level. Similarly, paddy acreage, too, trails by 4 per cent at 421.82 lh. The area under soybean and groundnut is lower by 1 lh from the year-ago number, official data as of September 4 show.

Motor insurance gets a personal touch

Insurers offer own-damage add-ons, named-driver plans and mileage-linked premium

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

Motor insurance is increasingly moving away from a one-size-fits-all approach to a personalised cover tailoring the premium to the risks specific to the vehicle and policyholder, thanks to a data-driven approach.

The personalisation in the own-damage component is visible in the growing range of modular covers available to customers, including return to invoice, nil depreciation, consumables cover and engine protector, and allowing policyholders to build protection around their individual requirements.

"Motor insurance in India has steadily evolved towards greater personalisation and customer-centricity. Customers today have the flexibility to opt for coverage that makes their



Personalisation is linking insurance more closely to actual vehicle usage and driving patterns

insurance modular and comprehensive," said Amarnath Saxena, Chief Technical Officer-Commercial, Bajaj General Insurance.

USAGE-BASED COVER

Personalisation is linking insurance more closely to actual vehicle usage and driving patterns. Usage-based motor insurance, for instance, allows customers to declare the distance they expect to drive in a year, with the premium aligned to

that usage. A customer declaring an annual usage of, say, 10,000 km can, therefore, have the cover structured around the expected extent of vehicle use.

There is also 'Named Driver' cover, under which the insured declares the licensed individuals who will drive the vehicle. This information can have a direct bearing on risk assessment and pricing, Saxena said.

Insurers are also offering bundled add-ons, combining multiple protections into a single package.

Personalisation is also extending to occupational requirements as insurers are now tailoring cover to specific employment requirements, including those of defence personnel.

Amit Goel, Director & Principal Officer, Equirus Raghnaal Insurance Broking, said: "Motor insurance is gradually moving from

being an asset-based product to a data- and usage-driven product."

DIGITAL DRIVE

According to Ramit Goyal, Chief Distribution Officer, Generali Central Insurance, digital platforms are further reshaping the business model by simplifying the entire customer journey, prompting insurers to invest in automation, artificial intelligence, analytics and digital claims management capabilities.

"The motor insurance business is expected to become increasingly digital, data-led and customer-centric," he said.

Connected vehicles could eventually provide insurers with richer information on driving behaviour, vehicle usage, location, mileage and risk patterns, creating the possibility of more sophisticated risk-based pricing.

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CM YK        M CH-CHE

MoD allocates ₹400 crore for defence diplomacy, plans 90 wings by 2030-end

MIGHTY MOVE. Government nudges defence wings to boost export and international co-operation

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Ministry of Defence (MoD) plans to increase its military diplomacy outreach to the entire globe by establishing 85-90 defence wings by the end of 2030. The priority is to place corresponding officers in 12 countries that have already deployed their respective defence attaches in their embassies in New Delhi. But India has not done this so far.

The defence wings act as forward nodes of defence diplomacy and industry outreach with host nations.

As of now, India has about 54 defence wings in missions abroad, internal MoD information accessed by *businessline* revealed. Of this, two are in the US, 11 in Africa, 10 in Europe, 30 in Asia and two in the Oceania region. Ten more defence wings were approved by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh in 2024, which are in the process of getting established, taking the total to 62.

Of the new wings, three more will be opened in the US, four in Africa, one in Europe and one will be taken out of Asia, as per changes



REGIONAL OUTREACH. India is expanding concessional defence credit to strengthen regional security and capacity

made in the strategy.

Moreover, to facilitate regular dialogue and engagement, instead of opening a new defence office in every single country, accreditation has been given to 50 existing ones to cover neighbouring nations.

This way, the outreach can be expanded to an overall 157 countries, as per the MoD's plan.

DIPLOMACY FUND

The defence diplomacy fund, launched in FY22 with a corpus of ₹110 crore, is drafted into the revenue budget of the Army, the Air Force (IAF) and the Navy. Since FY25, the Coast Guard has been funds to increase India's strategic outreach by way of offering gifts and gratis to friendly foreign countries,

like in Africa, with significant defence material, equipment and infrastructure support.

The fund was increased to ₹150 crore in FY23, and the budget remained the same in FY24, but there was a significant jump to ₹300 crore in FY25 and to ₹400 crore in FY26.

The government is giving a nudge to defence wings and reorienting the role of defence attaches (DAs), who are drawn from the Army, the Navy and the Air Force and posted as diplomats in embassies and consulates abroad, to promote exports and cooperation with countries.

Sources said the DAs have been withdrawn from many countries from which equipment was being imported to those regions and nations to

which India is exporting or has potential for future trade. India has set a defence export target of ₹50,000 crore by 2030, up from ₹38,424 crore in FY26.

Besides this, India is looking to enhance the presence of liaison officers in multinational constructs and host countries in West Africa, the Mediterranean, Latin America, the Caribbean and Pacific Island. As of now, India has positioned 2 international liaison officers for co-operation with organisations and between nations and 4 more will be deputed in the near future, as per the Ministry's blueprint.

Positioning of international liaison officers enables real-time access to policy discussion, intelligence inputs and decision-making processes, allowing India to shape outcomes and provide a faster crisis response.

OTHER MILESTONES

This is in addition to the 'Bharat Maitree Shakti Scheme,' through which New Delhi has increasingly extended dedicated concessional defence lines of credit to boost defence exports, maritime security and capacity building to adjoining

countries like Vietnam, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Mauritius, Maldives and many in the African continent.

The other milestones flagged are by way of defence industrial collaboration, aimed through initiatives like the global shipyard model. This approach also serves as a calibrated response to expanding Chinese maritime influence under the Belt and Road Initiative, with India emphasising transparency, sustainability and capacity building rather than debt-driven engagement, the strategic roadmap reveals.

The model is anchored in the government's massive ₹69,725-crore shipbuilding reform package unveiled late last year. By leveraging partnerships with global leaders like South Korea and Japan, India intends to promote green shipping, aiming for 30 per cent of the fleet to use clean fuels by 2047 and reduce the current \$110 billion annual outflow to foreign vessels.

Minister Rajnath Singh, on September 3, released the 'Raksha' framework, which outlines the roadmap over the next 10 years.

Rentomojo targets growth as rental assets generate repeat revenue

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Rentomojo is taking its rental model to the public markets with a ₹1,256 crore IPO, but the more interesting part of its pitch may be what happens to a sofa or refrigerator after the first customer is done with it.

The company's RHP shows its FY17 asset cohort has generated 5.12 times its original asset cost in revenue as furniture and appliances are refurbished, redeployed and rented out again.

Chairperson, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Geetansh Bamanian has described this as a model where the business can keep extracting value from the same asset across multiple customer cycles.

The IPO, opening on September 9, comprises ₹150 crore of fresh capital and ₹1,106 crore of an offer for sale, valuing the company at about ₹4,246 crore at the upper end of the price band. "We did not have a primary need for capital," Bamanian told *businessline*, adding that the IPO would partly reduce the company's cost of capital by repaying higher-cost debt.

ASSET OCCUPANCY

Its asset occupancy stood around 83-84 per cent in



Geetansh Bamanian, Chairperson, MD and CEO, Rentomojo

FY26. Rentomojo's operating revenue rose 45.5 per cent to ₹387 crore in FY26, while profit after tax more than doubled to ₹104.3 crore from the ₹43.1 crore a year earlier.

"Whenever we grow rapidly, there can be some pressure on the EBITDA margin," Bamanian said, describing Rentomojo as a "front-ended cash flow business" because delivery, repair and maintenance costs

are incurred upfront when an asset is deployed.

That makes asset productivity increasingly important as the company expands beyond its established markets.

NEWER MARKET

Rentomojo had 2.54 lakh live subscribers across 29 cities as of March 2026. Yet its revenue remains heavily concentrated: 98.19 per cent of FY26 operating revenue came from furniture and appliance rentals, while its top 10 cities accounted for 89.51 per cent of revenue, according to the RHP.

The company is also entering markets such as Indore and Lucknow, partly following customers who relocated there. The challenge, however, will be to replicate its asset economics as it moves into newer markets without having to disproportionately increase inventory, warehouse and logistics costs.



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No. MRU/ ENGG/Tender Advt/2026-27/ 05.09.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Tenders are invited from eligible bidders through e-procurement window of Government of Kerala (www.etenders.kerala.gov.in) for the following work.

Item	Closing Date & Time
Interior works of New HO, MRCMPU Ltd	28.09.2026
E-tender ID: 2026_KCMMF_866991_1	10.00 AM

For further enquiries, visit our website or contact Head Office, MRCMPU Ltd.
Managing Director

As coal reserves fall, more TPPs left with critical stocks

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Coal stocks at thermal power plants (TPPs) have fallen nearly 29 per cent in just over a month, from 38 million tonnes (mt) at the end-July to 27.14 mt on September 4 as supply disruptions coincide with sustained power demand.

The number of plants with critical coal stocks has also risen from 51 to 57 in just five days, indicating that roughly one-third of the cumulative operating coal-based capacity of roughly 224 gigawatts (GW) is now carrying critical supplies.

According to the latest Coal and Power Ministry data, the number of plants with critical stocks rose to 57 on September 4, up from 51 on August 31. At the end of July 2026, TPPs had 38 mt of coal stocks, which declined to 29.12 mt at the end of August and further to 27.14 mt on September 4.

DECLINE REASONS

A major reason for the decline in stocks at the TPP end is that historically, supplies get stretched during monsoon, as rains hinder mining activity and transport.

Thermal power plants with critical coal stocks				
	DCB plants	ICB plants	Washery rejects	Total stocks (MT)
August 31	46	4	1	29.12
September 1	40	4	1	28.64
September 2	45	4	1	28.17
September 3	50	4	1	27.59
September 4	52	4	1	27.14

Source: National Power Portal. DCB: Domestic Coal Based Plants; ICB: Imported Coal Based Plants; Washery Rejects: Plants based on Washery coal rejects; Total Stocks: Cumulative Coal Stocks at Plant-end Pan-India.

Another reason is that TPPs are burning more coal due to the high power demand since April, which has stretched into August as high heat and humidity is pushing up cooling demand.

For instance, energy consumption in July was around 171 billion units (BU) — the highest on record for any month — driven by a spurt in usage of cooling equipment, amid a rainfall deficit triggered by El Nino, according to Crisil Intelligence.

Rising electricity demand during evening and night hours, due to more than the average maximum and minimum temperature and humidity, has pushed up buy bids on power exchanges.

For instance, the Indian Energy Exchange (IEX) recorded a monthly electricity traded volume of 13,527 BUs in July 2026.

The frantic buying activity

also pushed up prices. The average market clearing price (MCP) in the Day-Ahead Market at the IEX stood at ₹4.88 per unit in August, a 22 per cent y-o-y increase.

Similarly, the average MCP in the real-time market stood at ₹4.41 a unit, registering a 30.4 per cent y-o-y growth.

MINISTRY'S RESPOND

Media reports pointed out that stretched coal supplies at TPPs in Punjab had forced the Coal Ministry to respond.

"The Ministry of Coal clarifies that adequate coal has been made available to Punjab's power plants, and Coal India remains fully committed to ensuring uninterrupted coal supply for power generation across the country, including in the State of Punjab," the Ministry added.

FSSAI suspends licences of Kailash Formulation, Sanecure Water

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has suspended the licences of West Bengal-based Kailash Formulation and Sanecure Water Project after uncovering severe violations of hygiene, sanitation and compliance standards.

"Enforcement drives led to the suspension of FSSAI licences for Kailash Formulation and Sanecure Water Project due to severe violations of hygiene, sanitation and compliance standards," it said in a social media post.

Packaged drinking water company Sanecure Water Project's licence was suspended for contraventions and major violations of regulations, it said.

"Poor hygiene and sanitation, inadequate pest-proofing and significant pest infestation were observed, raising serious concerns over food safety," it said.

For Kailash Formulations, overall hygiene and sanitation of the premises were found to be unsatisfactory, it added. Non-compliance in packaging and raw materials was also observed, the food safety regulator noted.

Hiring decisions pick up speed, but long notice periods creating a new recruitment bottleneck

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Indian companies are moving faster to close hiring decisions, but long notice periods and a growing shortage of specialised talent are making it harder to get people on board quickly, creating a new bottleneck between making an offer and having the employee join, according to hiring experts.

According to CareerNet data, the time from raising a requisition to extending an offer fell from 53 days in FY25 to 46 days in FY26, an improvement in how fast companies are closing roles. Notice periods, however, have barely changed.

The average gap between accepting an offer and joining remained around 30-33 days across both years. Roughly 29-31 per cent of the hires still took 60 days or more to join after accepting an offer.

"Nearly a third of hires take two months or longer to join after accepting an offer

Recruitment timeline				
City / seniority	Notice Period (no. of days)		Time-to-hire (no. of days)	
	FY26	FY25	FY26	FY25
NCR	38	28	43.5	56
Hyderabad	35	33	47	67
Bengaluru	33	33	43	46
Chennai	29	24	60	52
Mumbai	30.5	36	43	49
Pune	22	43.5	48	63
0-3 years	33	33	38	42
3-7 years	31	31	50	59
7-12 years	33	38	49.5	57
12+ years	41	43.5	40	56

Source: CareerNet

— a significant gap between making the hiring decision and the person coming on board. During that period, companies are also managing the risk of counteroffers, drop-offs or losing the candidate to another opportunity," Neelabh Shukla, Chief Business Officer, CareerNet, explained.

In a competitive talent market, this puts more pressure on hiring teams to consider availability, alongside skills and fit. A candidate who can join sooner may have an advantage when two

candidates are otherwise comparable.

TURNAROUND TIME

Meanwhile, Adecco noted that in its flexi staffing business, the turnaround time expected by clients had come down to 24 hours. Notice periods continue to range from 30 to 90 days, with 90 days being common for senior hires.

In CareerNet's placements, hiring volume for AI, machine learning and data science roles grew by about 48 per cent y-o-y. The aver-

age time-to-hire for these roles increased from 38 days to 63 days. Employers are opening more AI-related positions, but taking longer to close them.

CAREERNET DATA

As per CareerNet data, GCCs' average time-to-hire is 37-38 days, as opposed to non-GCC employers at 54-65 days. However, they face a challenge after the offer is made. GCCs have the longest notice-period wait, at 41-42 days compared with 27-28 days for non-GCC companies. They are also the only segment where the share of hires taking 60 days or more to join increased y-o-y, from 35.7 per cent to 36.5 per cent.

Ganesh S Padmanabhan, VP, Recruitment Business at CIEL HR, said, "Long notice periods add friction when global companies are competing for a limited pool of experienced specialists. They do not, by themselves, undermine India's competitiveness, but they can slow execution."



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CIN L25199KL1993PLC007018

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NOTICE OF THE 33RD ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING (AGM) ON 29TH SEPTEMBER, 2026 AT 11.00 A.M.

Notice is hereby given that the 33rd Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the Members of Rubfila International Limited ("Company") (CIN: L25199KL1993PLC007018) to be held on Tuesday, 29th September, 2026 at 11.00 AM through Video Conferencing ("VC") / Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM"), in compliance with General Circular No.14/2020 dt.08/04/2020, General Circular No.17/2020 dt.13/04/2020, Circular No.20/2020 dt.05/05/2020, Circular No.02/2021 dt.13.01.2021, Circular No. 02/2022 dt. 05/05/2022, Circular No.09/2023 dated September 25, 2023 and Circular No. 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 and all other applicable laws and circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA), Government of India and Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CMD1/CIR/P/2020/79, SEBI/HO/CFD/CMD2/CIR/P/2021/11 and SEBI/HO/CFD/CMD2/CIR/P/2022/62 dt. 12th May,2020, 15th January, 2021 and 13th May, 2022, 5th January 2023, 7th October 2023, 03rd October 2024 respectively issued by Security Exchange Board of India ("SEBI Circulars"), allowing the Companies to conduct the AGM through VC/OAVM, to transact the business as set out in the notice of Annual General Meeting, which has been sent in permitted mode to all shareholders. The AGM notice and other documents are available on the Company's website, www.rubfila.com, the website of Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL) at www.evotingindia.com and the website of the Bombay Stock Exchange Limited at www.bseindia.com and the website of National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com

In compliance with Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 and with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended, and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company is providing the Members the facility to exercise their right to vote by electronic means and the business may be transacted through remote e-voting services provided by CDSL.

Shareholders holding shares either in physical form or dematerialized form, as on the cut-off date Tuesday, 22nd September 2026, may cast their votes electronically on the business as set forth in the Notice of the AGM through the electronic voting system ('remote e-voting'), the details of which are given below:

A	Statement on businesses to be transacted by electronic voting.	Business set out in Notice dated 20th August, 2026, may be transacted by electronic voting
B	Date of completion of sending notice of AGM	05th September 2026
C	Cut-off date for determining the eligibility to vote by remote voting or e-voting at AGM	Tuesday, 22nd September 2026
D	Date and time of commencement of remote e-voting	Saturday, 26th September 2026 (9.00 AM)
E	Date time of ending of remote e-voting	Monday, 28th September 2026 (5.00 PM)
F	The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL after 5:00 p.m. IST on Monday, 28th September 2026 and once the votes on a resolution is cast by the shareholder, the shareholder will not be allowed to change it subsequently.	
G	Website details of the Company/Agency, where the Notice of AGM is displayed.	www.rubfila.com
H	Contact details of the person responsible to address the grievances connected with electronic voting and technical assistance to access and participate in the meeting through VC.	Mr. Rakesh Dalvi, Sr. Manager, (CDSL) Central Depository Services (India) Limited, A Wing, 25 th Floor, Marathon Futurex, Mafatlal Mill Compounds, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (East), Mumbai - 400013 or send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdsindia.com or call toll free no. 1800 22 55 33.

Any person, who acquires shares of the company and becomes a shareholder post-dispatch of the Notice of the AGM and holds shares as on the cut-off date i.e. Tuesday, 22nd September 2026, may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request to helpdesk.evoting@cdsindia.com. However, if a person is already registered with CDSL for e-voting, then the existing user ID and password can be used for casting their vote. Any person who is not a shareholder / ceased to be a shareholder as on the cut-off date should treat this notice for information purpose only.

The notice of the AGM will be made available on the Company's website, at www.rubfila.com under "Annual Report" section, website of the stock exchanges viz., BSE Limited at https://www.bseindia.com/ , National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and on the CDSL website, at www.evotingindia.com.

Shareholders may note that:

- The facility for e-voting will be made available during the AGM, and those shareholders present in the AGM through VC/OAVM facility, shall be eligible to vote through the e-voting system at the AGM.
- Any Member, who has already exercised his votes through remote e-voting, may attend the Meeting but will not be permitted to vote at the Meeting and his/her vote, if any, cast at the Meeting shall be treated as invalid.
- Only persons whose names are recorded in the register of members or in the register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting at the AGM.
- The voting right of shareholders shall be in proportion to their share in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the cut-off date, being Tuesday, 22nd September 2026.
- The shareholders can join the AGM in the VC/OAVM mode 15 minutes before the scheduled time of the commencement of the Meeting by using the remote e-voting login credentials and by following the procedure mentioned in this Notice. The facility to join through VC/OAVM will be available for shareholders on first come first serve basis.

Shareholders will have an opportunity to cast their vote through the e-voting system during the meeting on the business as may be set forth in the Notice of the AGM through electronic voting system. The manner of voting remotely for shareholders holding shares in dematerialized mode, physical mode and for shareholders who have not registered their email addresses will be provided in the Notice of the AGM.

CS. Sreekumar P.S., Partner, M/s. SVJS & Associates, Company Secretaries, Kochi has been appointed as Scrutinizer for conducting the e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner. The results of the voting will be announced by the Company on its website www.rubfila.com and the website of CDSL www.evotingindia.com and will also be intimated to BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited.

Shareholders may please note that, in terms of the aforementioned circulars, the Company will not be sending physical copies of AGM Notice to the shareholders.

Shareholders holding shares in physical form are requested to register their email addresses with the Share Transfer Agents of the Company M/s. Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited at their email address: einward@integratedindia.in by submitting the Form ISR-1 and the Form ISR-2 could be downloaded from the website of RTA at forms download option under the link https://www.integratedregistry.in /KYCRegister.aspx. Those holding shares in demat form are requested to register their email IDS with their Depository Participants.

By Order of the Board of Directors
RUBFILA INTERNATIONAL LTD
Sd/-
N.N.Parameswaran
Chief Finance Officer & Company Secretary

Palakkad
05.09.2026



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ON THE CAMPAIGN TRAIL.

Socially relevant campaigns caught the eye in the fortnight gone by, as did a very cool ‘moment marketing’ campaign from a brand that endearingly laughed at itself

Tough conversations

To mark World Alzheimer’s month, the Tata Trusts has launched ‘Vajood Rahe Maujood’, a new campaign on dementia awareness that seeks to shift the conversation around the condition from memory loss to the gradual loss of identity. Based on insights from people living with early-stage dementia, caregivers and medical experts, the campaign highlights how dementia can progressively affect the roles, relationships and everyday abilities that shape a person’s sense of self. Through an evocative film, the campaign aims to help families recognise early changes, start conversations sooner and take steps to preserve the identity of their loved ones for as long as possible. The film brings together actor Geeta Agarwal Sharma of *Laapataa Ladies* and *12th Fail* fame, who plays a mother showing early signs of dementia, and Priyanshu Painyuli (who played Robin in the web series *Mirzapur*) essaying the role of her son. The choice of a female protagonist reflects the disproportionate impact of dementia on women.

Easy grow

Nurturing takes on a whole new dimension in gardening platform Ugao’s latest campaign, which uses humour to show how easy plant parenting can be. Built around Jackie Shroff’s legendary love for plants, the film ropes in the actor’s son, Tiger Shroff, who shares how tough it was to get his dad’s attention. As Tiger looks back at his childhood, his backflips, bodybuilding and quirky personality are hilariously attributed to his attempts to compete with his father’s plant babies for the spotlight. It is a playful way to weave in Ugao USP — that plant parenting doesn’t have to demand so much from you. The film was conceptualised and produced by Kulfi Collective, with White Rivers Media as digital media partner.

Baseline shift

A pronunciation mistake became an occasion for a clever ‘moment marketing’ campaign. It all began when South Korean beauty creator Min Day Lee posted a video showing off her massive collection of Vaseline products, repeatedly mispronouncing the brand name as “Baseline” due to the lack of a “V” sound in Korean phonetics. People cracked jokes and shared the video, but Vaseline decided to join the fun, executing a brilliant real-time moment marketing campaign by temporarily rebranding its social media channels to “Baseline”. It took the joke further by saying it was appointing Min Day Lee as the CEO of Baseline. The brand won over the internet.

NUGGET.

Building up the festive consumer consideration

Traditionally, brands plan campaigns around fixed festival dates. But is that approach correct? A new report says that festive consumer consideration in India can begin building up nearly eight weeks before the festive peak. Taboola’s performance advertising platform Realize’s festive playbook 2026, ‘Light the Right Moments’, offers a data-led view of how consumer decision-making evolves across India’s festival period. One of the playbook’s key findings is that there is no single festive decision window. The technology, automotive, home, finance, fashion, jewellery and travel segments each follow different patterns of consumer consideration across the festival season. While some categories see interest building up earlier and remain active over an extended period, others are more closely linked to specific festive occasions or shorter periods of heightened intent. AI is also reshaping the journey, making it significantly faster for consumers to move from search to a shortlist. But the playbook finds that building confidence still takes time. Consumers continue to validate important decisions through multiple sources, including reviews, comparisons, expert perspectives, brand content, retailers and trusted publishers. The path from discovering an option to feeling confident enough to choose it, therefore, remains an active process of research and validation across the open internet. For brands, the task is to identify when consideration begins within their own category and build relevance from that point, rather than waiting for the festive peak to show up.

SHOCK TACTICS

When provocation becomes the product

IS RISQUE RISKY? From liquor counters to Instagram checkouts, brands are packing titillation into products and the buying experience

Amit Vijay Mohile

It was around 8.30 pm when Rahul Chhibber, a 32-year-old consultant, stopped at a South Delhi *theka* and told the salesman, “*Chaar BroCode dena. Full maza hai isme.*” The salesman handed over the four bottles of IndoBevs’ 15 per cent ABV (alcohol by volume) carbonated wine that Chhibber wanted, and threw in the company’s latest brand extension, BroTection — a packet of condoms. “Extra *maza ke liye*,” he said with a wink. BroCode, BroTection. The transaction itself had become the advertisement. From liquor counters to Instagram checkouts, brands are turning risqué positioning into products, purchase occasions and transactions across consumer categories worth an estimated ₹40,000 crore. “We are moving from risqué communication to risqué brand architecture,” says brand strategy specialist Harish Bijoor. “Earlier, the provocation typically sat in the advertising. What brands are experimenting with now is putting it into the product, the occasion and even the transaction.” Men’s innerwear is making a similar turn. Lux Cozi, VIP, Rupa Frontline and Amul Macho built mass recall around masculinity, humour and innuendo, most memorably Macho’s “*Yeh toh bada toing hai*”. Now D2C brand UNDRRESS is pitching ₹799–1,399 intimatewear around the female gaze, dates and intimacy. Instead of selling underwear primarily as an everyday necessity, UNDRRESS is associating it with occasions where consumers consciously want to look and feel desirable — a first date, Gen Z hook-up, Valentine’s Day, honeymoon or



PLEASURE PRINCIPLE. Desire as unique selling proposition



weekend away with a partner. Desire becomes a reason to trade up. “The Risqué 2.0 playbook is a brilliantly pragmatic strategy,” says Prathap Suthan, Chief Creative Officer at Bang In The Middle. “What we are seeing is the weaponisation of the transaction.” Brands, he says, are moving provocation “into products, retail and checkout”.

COMMERCIAL CANVAS The sexual wellness and condoms market is estimated at ₹12,300 crore annually; men’s intimatewear at ₹18,000–22,000 crore; male grooming and deodorants at ₹5,500–6,500 crore; and ready-to-drink alcobevs at ₹2,500–3,200 crore — cumulatively ₹38,300–44,000 crore, according to industry estimates. RTD alcobevs demand is estimated to be growing 18–22 per cent annually, men’s intimatewear 11.5–

13 per cent, male grooming 8.5–10 per cent and sexual wellness 6–11 per cent. BroCode clocks ₹200–250 crore annual retail sales, while IndoBevs targets more than ₹700 crore in branded alcobeve revenue in FY27. Risqué marketing isn’t new. Benetton used visual shock, FCUK sexual wordplay and Calvin Klein sensuality; in India, Tuff Shoes’ campaign featuring Milind Soman and Madhu Sapre in the buff courted controversy, while MR Coffee promised that “Real pleasure doesn’t come in an instant”. “Risqué advertising has been used globally for brands ranging from apparel, fashion and alcohol to even ice cream,” says advertising veteran Ambi Parameswaran. “In India, we are still using this form of advertising to sell undergarments and alcohol, after the misstep of Tuff Shoes.”



Sameer Mahandru, Founder, IndoBevs

“What we are seeing now is a doubling down by the same categories on their own version of risqué advertising, now with products to taunt consumers with,” he added. This marks the divide between the two playbooks. Risqué 1.0 largely used provocation to win attention and recall. Risqué 2.0 carries it into commerce: BroCode takes it to the liquor counter, BroTection into sexual wellness and UNDRRESS into premium intimatewear. BroTection’s collaboration with sexual-wellness brand Bold Care makes the crossover explicit with the tagline “Have Fun. Not Kids”. “We are done hiding behind soda,” says IndoBevs founder Sameer Mahandru. “If we are going to do surrogate advertising, it will reflect the reality of our consumers’ lives, not a sanitised version of it.” **DIGITAL MAKES IT EASY** Risqué 2.0 also has something its predecessors did not: Digital infrastructure capable of turning provocation into a transaction almost instantly. A Gen Z hook-up, honeymoon, Valentine’s date, house party or weekend away can begin with

Streaming six-yard sales through YouTube Live

Shakthi H

What does an IT career have to do with a saree business? For Chennai-based Ramya Devanathan, quite a lot. After 18 years at Tata Consultancy Services, she turned an attire that has been a part of her life since her teenage years into a business. The Covid-19 pandemic, which pushed consumers to buy everything — from groceries to medicines — online, gave her an opportunity. Devanathan decided to take the saree online too, via Madras Sarees — choosing a D2C model instead of investing in physical retail, and paying homage to her city through the brand name. Festivals and occasions have long driven saree purchases, but Devanathan saw few options for affordable sarees meant for work and everyday wear. That was the space Madras Sarees chose to explore, retailing cotton and silk sarees. There

are linen-cotton sarees at ₹999, aimed at those who wear sarees regularly to work. But a saree is not a simple product to sell. Devanathan points to the variables involved — fabric, weave, construction, regional identity, colour, drape and price. The way a saree is made can also vary, from handloom and powerloom weaving to techniques such as jacquard and printing. That breadth makes it challenging to position the category, says Jermina Menon, Brand and Marketing Strategist at Bhartiya Urban. Handloom, she notes, is a “beautiful” word, but can make a saree more expensive. A brand, therefore, needs to be clear about the customer and price point it is addressing, she says. The challenge becomes more pronounced online, as consumers cannot touch or feel the fabric. Madras Sarees uses YouTube Live commerce to take customers through details such as the saree’s fabric, construction, regional identity and authenticity, says Devanathan. The format also allows them to view the flow and weave of the saree,



IN A D2C DRAPE. Madras Sarees founder Ramya Devanathan



while covering measurements, wash care and styling details. She recalls a doctor who had to suddenly rush to surgery when she was watching a live session and had spotted a saree colour she liked. Unable to make the payment immediately, she sent a WhatsApp message asking the team to block the saree until she could return to complete the purchase. Getting a customer to make the first purchase is only part of the equation. Menon says a brand should also

give customers a reason to come back. Performance marketing can help generate the initial sale, she says, but the product must do the talking after that. Madras Sarees is also looking beyond conventional retail touchpoints. Devanathan says a saree kiosk has been set up in the city’s Abhiramapuram area, with the broader idea of locating such outlets in spaces where consumers are usually waiting for some other service — such as a

salon, where a client waiting for a hairstylist’s appointment, or an electric vehicle recharge point, where a customer charging her car can browse the sarees, place an order and have it delivered to a destination. The idea, she says, is to create an alternative point of brand visibility and sales. What began as a D2C approach to selling sarees now raises a larger question: How and where do consumers discover them? Devanathan’s vision is to become a trusted pan-Indian saree brand that is proudly rooted in Madras. But would the name Madras Sarees limit its reach by giving a wrong impression that it retails only South Indian weaves? “The name Madras Sarees is our foundation, not our boundary,” she says, pointing to several global brands named after cities or regions. “While we deeply celebrate south Indian weaves, we also curate beautiful sarees from across India. Madras Sarees uses the city as a brand anchor, not a geographic restriction,” she concludes.

Why does India’s food safety system need a Clint Eastwood?

There is a simple digital way to fix it by publishing violation information automatically, online, and not locking it in a database

DIGITAL GADFLY



SHUBHO SENGUPTA

Between May and July this year, Tukaram Mundhe, a 2005 batch IAS officer from Beed, Maharashtra, reportedly walked into 3,137 restaurants, issued 764 improvement notices, and shut down 165 of the eateries. And became a *Singham*-style folk hero in the process, celebrated on social media and news channels as the bureaucrat who finally did what the system was supposed to do all along. The thing is, Maharashtra’s Food and Drug Administration has FoSCoS — the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India’s integrated digital platform — which is supposed to track licensing, inspections, lab results and penalties, with the whole chain digitised and connected. So you don’t really need a vigilante — it should be quiet, boring, predictable and effective work. There’s information, but no en-

forcement, not until Mundhe shows up. In theory, FoSCoS is elegant. Violation found → lab test ordered → results analysed → audit conducted → adjudication → penalty issued → restaurant closed. Clean. Logical. The system has too many blockers and not enough doers, however. Violations sit in audit, then in adjudication, then in enforcement — with each step a checkpoint that can delay matters indefinitely.

HOW OTHERS FIXED THIS Singapore has inspections and rules just like we do, but here’s the critical difference: When a restaurant fails inspection, the rating gets published right there on the storefront, online, everywhere customers see it. The owner doesn’t fear the inspector or worry about fines — he fears customers who see “Failed” and go somewhere else instead. Revenue drops the same week, the owner fixes the problem immediately, and market pressure does what bureaucracy never could. In Denmark and Australia, violations go public within days, the media picks it up... And if one dis-



CALLING OUT. Making it easy for consumers to report food safety issues

trict is lenient, the neighbouring district looks clean by comparison, so officials can’t hide. **WHAT INDIA SHOULDN’T DO** India needs to stop building systems for bureaucrats and start building systems for customers. Publication of violation data should be automatic — not locked in a database, but online within 48 hours, in food delivery apps, on restaurant windows, so customers know before they eat. Celebrating Mundhe is basically admitting the system doesn’t work. A folk hero in regulatory en-

forcement is like a folk hero in water supply — it means something fundamental is broken. Singapore doesn’t have headlines about its food safety commissioner, neither does Denmark, or Australia, because when a system works, it’s invisible. So the question isn’t where to find the next Mundhe but how to build a system that doesn’t need him. **MANY MUNDHES...** Also, I realised while I was writing this — the ‘Mundhe principle’ is portable. Let’s take a quick look at some

other industries and categories. Real estate: Buyers have no idea if a building was flagged for structural issues. But if property listings showed municipal violation history, demand drops for sketchy buildings and developers would rush to fix. TV channels: There’s official data on complaints against news channels for promoting fake news, hate speech, bias and so on. But if that data appeared where you were choosing what to watch... Schools: Education Department inspects and finds violations, but parents don’t see it. Imagine school violation data published where you’re comparing institutions — suddenly, principals would move faster. Hospitals: There is data on doctor complaints, disciplinary actions, malpractice cases. Patients don’t see any of it. You pick a doctor on reputation or luck. But if that data appeared in the public domain... The lesson isn’t that India needs more heroes. It’s that India needs to stop hoarding regulatory data.

Shubho Sengupta is a digital marketer with an analogue past

● ‘IN-BETWEEN’ STATE



ISTOCK

A discovery that can help ease drug delivery

Team Quantum

Scientists at the Raman Research Institute (RRI) have found a way to make tightly jammed materials briefly behave like liquids — by giving them a sudden temperature shock.

The discovery could have implications in areas such as drug delivery, where scientists need to control when and how a material changes its structure and releases its contents.

Some materials lie between solid and liquid states. Glass is a familiar example. It behaves like a solid — you can hold it, cut it and break it — but the arrangement of its particles is disordered, more like in a liquid.

Such materials can also retain a kind of “memory” of the changes they undergo. The path they take while being heated or cooled can affect their final structure and behaviour.

Scientists are interested in finding ways of erasing this memory and temporarily making such jammed systems flow, because that would give them greater control over the material. The RRI researchers explored one such method using tiny, soft particles known as microgels.

Sonali Kawale, the first author of the study and a PhD student at RRI, packed these squishy particles tightly together so they could barely move. The result was a jammed system resembling glass, with particles locked in a disordered arrangement. Microgels can absorb 300-500 times their weight in water and are used in products such as diapers and sanitary napkins.

“Squeezing is never a good thing,” said Ranjini Bandyopadhyay, a co-author of the study, published in the *Journal of Colloid and Interface Science*. “In an ideal environment, these particles would like to move around. But they can’t. So they’re unhappy. If the whole thing starts flowing, that’s a happy situation.”

The researchers found a way of making the particles a little happier, at least temporarily.

They prepared a suspension of the microgel particles in water and studied what happened when its temperature was changed. They found that the route followed by the system while heating to a particular temperature was different from the route it followed while cooling to the original temperature.

In other words, the system remembered where it had come from.

But then the researchers changed the rules. By suddenly increasing the rate at which the temperature was changed — effectively giving the material a thermal shock — they triggered a rearrangement of the tightly packed particles.

The jammed system temporarily became more liquid-like.

More importantly, this rearrangement wiped out much of the system’s memory of its earlier heating and cooling history. Scientists had previously observed such path-dependent behaviour, but the RRI team’s work shows that it can potentially be controlled.

In drug delivery, at lower temperatures, the microgel particles can swell up like balls of jelly and absorb a drug. When heated above a certain temperature — around 34 degrees C in the system studied — they collapse and squeeze out their contents.

Such behaviour could potentially be used to release a medicine at a targeted location, such as a tumour, reducing unwanted effects elsewhere in the body.

● HEAT DETECTOR

A crystal that defies thermoelectric rules

STATE OF SURPRISE. How researchers stumbled upon quantum-grade sensing in an ordinary-looking, thin semiconductor film

M Ramesh

Just as we move away from a hot place to a comfortably cool one, so do charge carriers (electrons and holes) in atoms. If you heat one end of a metal bar, the carriers migrate towards the cooler end. As some charged particles migrate, there develops a pushback against the migration, leaving the two ends with a difference in electrical charge — one end positive, the other negative. When this happens, you have a voltage.

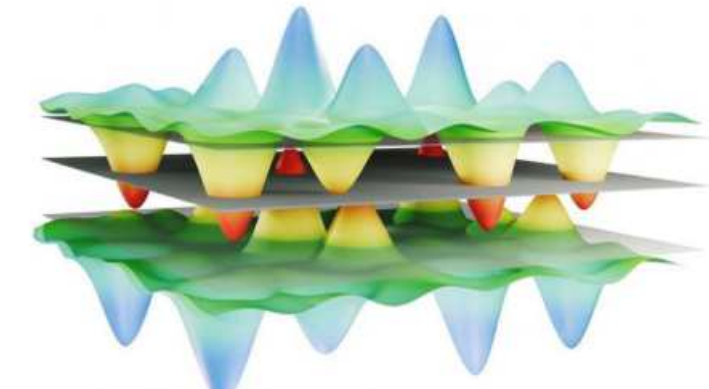
This was discovered in 1821 by Thomas Johann Seebeck, a German physicist of Baltic extraction. Seebeck was experimenting with circuits made of different metals when he noticed that a temperature difference could produce a magnetic effect near a compass needle — an observation that was later understood to arise from an electric current generated by heat.

He established, for the first time, a direct link between heat and electricity and laid the foundation for the science of thermoelectricity. Since then, the ‘Seebeck effect’ has been taught in high school physics textbooks.

Most metals produce Seebeck coefficients of only a few tens of microvolts per kelvin. Even good semiconductors typically manage a few hundred microvolts per kelvin. A few millivolts per kelvin was generally considered the upper end for crystalline solids.

Much larger values were the preserve of liquids and soft materials such as electrolytes, ionic gels and hydrogels, where ions rather than electrons move under a temperature gradient.

Now, a team led by Prof Bivas Saha of the Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Re-



A schematic electronic band diagram of heavily doped, highly compensated scandium nitride IMAGE COURTESY: JNCASR

search (JNCASR), working with researchers from the University of Sydney and the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), has reported a Seebeck coefficient exceeding –124.6 millivolts per kelvin near room temperature in a thin film of scandium nitride, which is of industrial significance.

That is several hundred times larger than the values normally associated with inorganic semiconductors, and nearly a hundred times beyond the previously accepted ceiling for crystalline solids.

The findings, published in *Science*, amount to something of a thermoelectric surprise: A solid crystal behaving, in one important respect, more like an electrolyte.

CAREFULLY ENGINEERED

The hero material — scandium nitride, or ScN — is a refractory transition-metal nitride. The researchers grew films of it on magnesium oxide substrates using ultra-high vacuum magnetron sputtering. Then came the crucial intervention.

ScN naturally contains free electrons, partly because of oxy-

gen impurities. The scientists deliberately introduced magnesium atoms, which compensated for these electrons. The result was what scientists call a heavily doped, highly compensated semiconductor.

In such a material, positive and negative dopant atoms are present in nearly equal numbers and are randomly distributed through the crystal. “We were not looking for a record-breaking number,” Prof Saha said. “We were trying to understand how disorder and charge compensation reshape electronic transport in scandium nitride.”

There was another surprise. The effect became stronger as the films were made thinner. The researchers have already taken the first step towards developing a device based on the phenomenon.

They fabricated a prototype photon sensor using a thin film of the highly compensated ScN, with two chromium contacts. A laser was shone on one of the contacts, heating it slightly and creating a tiny local temperature difference across the device. That small difference generated a measurable voltage corresponding to a See-

● WOW. The magnetic lie detector



M Ramesh

When Thomas Hoving stood before a 2,000-year-old marble kouros — statue of a nude Greek male — one word flashed in his mind: Fresh.

The J Paul Getty Museum in California had tested the kouros against fakery — the kouros had passed the test. The thin layer of calcite stamped it right — after all, it takes thousands of years for dolomite marble to turn into calcite.

Yet Hoving, a former Director of the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York, thought ‘fresh’.

Opening his book, *Blink*, Malcom Gladwell describes how it took teams of experts to

determine that the kouros was fake, while Hoving and a few others spotted it right away, intuitively.

Suppose you are an ancient-pottery forger. You have done a magnificent job. The clay is right. The shape is perfect. You have even given it a suitably battered appearance.

There is just one problem.

The earth remembers. When clay is fired in a kiln and cools, tiny magnetic minerals inside it line themselves up with the earth’s magnetic field, rather like microscopic compass needles. The resulting magnetic signature gets locked into the pottery. This is called thermal remanent magnetisation, or TRM.

Now, here is the catch for our unfortunate forger: Earth’s magnetic field does not stay put. Magnetic North wanders over time. So, a pot fired 2,000 years ago carries a subtly different magnetic signature from one made yesterday.

But there is more. Over centuries, ancient pottery slowly picks up a second, much weaker magnetic signal from the earth’s changing magnetic field. Scientists call this viscous remanent magnetisation, or VRM. For more than a century, researchers have largely regarded it as a nuisance — noise interfering with the stronger original signal.

The idea is deliciously simple: An ancient object has had centuries to acquire this secondary magnetic memory; a modern forgery has not. While this technique cannot tell you if the pot was made in 321 BC or 431 BC, it can assure you that it was not made last month.

Now, how did the kouros forger get the calcite layer? Well, turns out that you can ‘age’ dolomite marble using potato mold.

But that was in the early 1980s. Today, dear forger, things are different.

● AUTOMATING MARKETS

Machine learning to trade

N Nagaraj

In 1962, an economist named Vernon Smith ran an experiment with students at Purdue. Half got a slip with a secret number: The most they could pay for a pretend good. The other half got a different secret number: The least they’d accept to sell it. Nobody saw anyone else’s slip, and an auctioneer at the front simply called out and recorded each bid and ask, declaring a trade whenever one met the other. There was, unknown to any of them, a single price — the point economists call the ‘equilibrium’ — at which the gains available from the whole market were as large as possible.

Yet, round after round of calling out numbers and haggling, strangers with no shared information beyond overheard bids and asks had pushed prices strikingly close to it, as though the room had solved a puzzle none of them could individually see. This is the double auction, the mechanism underlying most centralised financial and commodity markets. Smith would go on to share the 2002 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences for establishing laboratory experiments as a tool of economic analysis.

Large language models now take on the roles once played by Smith’s students, negotiating and trading on people’s behalf. A team of four researchers tested whether AI agents reproduce Smith’s result in their recent study, titled *Competitive market behaviour of LLMs*.

They built a Smith-style double auction adapted for AI agents: 11 buyers, 11 sellers, each with a private reservation price, trading through an order book that accepted only improving quotes. Every trader was an AI agent — drawn from a large OpenAI model; a smaller and cheaper sibling of the same family; and a large Google model — each run 10 times over.

None of the three converged fully to the competitive equilibrium. Prices stayed well above what Smith’s humans had managed, and trading volume often fell short of the six trades the equilibrium implied. This wasn’t a failure of arith-



ISTOCK

metic; each agent was explicitly told to maximise profit and was given its own reservation price. The failure sat somewhere between understanding a market and knowing how to behave inside one.

It was not the flagship model that came closest to functioning as a market. The larger, more capable OpenAI model produced the worst market of the three. Its agents kept improving their quotes in one cent increments and simply refused to close the gap, so trading volume fell to between a third and two-thirds of the equilibrium quantity — rent-seeking taken to a self-defeating extreme.

The smaller, cheaper sibling behaved rather better. Its buyers and sellers leapt across meaningful price gaps rather than inching toward them and, round over round, its markets tightened in the same broad pattern Smith’s humans had shown, with efficiency climbing above 90 per cent by the final round. It behaved as though it were, in some rough sense, adapting to the structure of the game. The researchers are careful not to oversell this, since their design wasn’t meant to isolate the effect of model size, but it echoes other research suggesting that greater sophistication doesn’t necessarily make AI traders more human-like.

One model provides reasoning traces as it trades, and combing through them shows a pattern: While an agent shaved cents off its offer, its language was dominated by words like ‘strategic’ and ‘optimise’ — the vocabulary of protecting a margin. The moment it leapt across the spread to trade, that vocabulary shifted toward ‘immediate’, ‘secure’, ‘guarantee’ — the vocabulary of urgency. The researchers caution that the stated reasoning need not match the

computation actually driving it, but the shift suggests two instincts in tension: One protecting profit, and one eventually panicking about ending the round with nothing sold.

AI agents are already being used for pricing, negotiation, bidding and financial tasks. The mechanisms within which they operate were built around assumptions about how human traders behave, and a mechanism that reliably squeezes efficiency out of self-interested humans may need different rules, or a human hand at the wheel, when the traders are language models instead.

The same caution applies to research using language models as stand-ins for human subjects: Smith’s result is one of the most robust findings in experimental economics, and even here the language models didn’t reproduce it off the shelf.

There’s a narrower implication, too. Some researchers read the repeated small price adjustments by AI agents as evidence of collusion. But calling a price “collusive” only makes sense against a baseline of what honest, non-colluding agents would produce, and the obvious baseline is the competitive equilibrium. If AI agents on their own can’t reliably find that equilibrium in the first place, a price sitting above it isn’t necessarily proof of a conspiracy.

Whether AI agents can ever be trusted inside markets built for humans remains open. The institution that let a room of anonymous 1962 undergraduates turn scattered private information into a remarkably accurate public price does not, on the evidence here, produce the same result with machines. At least not yet, and not without knowing rather more about which machines, and why.

India brings a small machine to the fusion race

The country deploys its first spherical tokamak to see if it can produce high-pressure, stable plasma

Venkatachari Jagannathan

The Institute for Plasma Research (IPR) in Gujarat has commissioned India’s first spherical tokamak and begun plasma experiments, marking the country’s entry into a specialised area of fusion research.

Behind the compact machine lies a big question: Can scientists learn to control on earth the same process that powers the sun, and eventually use it to generate electricity?

A tokamak uses powerful magnetic fields to hold an extremely hot gas called plasma. Under extreme conditions, atoms can fuse together and release enormous amounts of energy. This process, nuclear fusion, is what powers the sun.

Conventional tokamaks are broadly doughnut-shaped. A spherical tokamak is more compact and resembles a hollowed-out apple. Scientists are studying whether this configuration can produce high-pressure plasma in a smaller ma-

chine. The first plasma was produced on December 11, 2025, and scientists have since carried out 114 plasma discharges. They, however, found that when the magnetic system is switched on, large unwanted electrical currents are induced in the metal walls of the vessel.

These currents, in turn, produce magnetic effects that interfere with the plasma. The researchers are exploring ways to compensate for the unwanted current by changing the arrangement of the magnetic coils or using additional sources.

The vacuum inside the machine has improved substantially through regular glow-discharge cleaning, to remove gases and impurities from the vessel walls. Further wall-conditioning methods are being optimised. For the IPR, beyond producing plasma the challenge is to make it last longer and remain stable.

GLOBAL EFFORT

India is not alone in pursuing spherical tokamak technology. The UK has the Mega Ampere Spherical



SUN ON EARTH. Bright plasma glows inside the reactor vessel of the Mega Ampere Spherical Tokamak in Culham, UK

Tokamak Upgrade (MAST-U), while private company Tokamak Energy is developing the ST40 spherical tokamak. Britain is also working on the Spherical Tokamak for Energy Production (STEP), a prototype fusion power plant.

The US has the National Spherical Torus Experiment Upgrade (NSTX-U) at the Princeton Plasma Physics Laboratory.

Japan has the Q-shu University

Experiment with Steady-State Spherical Tokamak (QUEST).

China, South Korea, Russia, Italy and Spain also have spherical tokamak research programmes.

BENEFITS

Commercial fusion power is still some distance away. But the potential prize is enormous.

If successful, it could provide large quantities of low-carbon electricity. Unlike conventional nuclear fission, fusion does not depend on a chain reaction. If the conditions needed for fusion disappear, the reaction stops.

But fusion cannot yet be described as cheap electricity. Nobody knows what commercial fusion power will ultimately cost.

The significance of India’s spherical tokamak, therefore, lies not in the electricity it can produce today, but the knowledge and expertise it can build for the future.

The writer is an independent journalist based in Chennai

NAVI MUMBAI AIRPORT USHERS
IN GLOBAL CARGO GIANTS



The Navi Mumbai International Airport welcomed the Antonov An-124 ‘Ruslan’, one of the world’s largest production cargo aircraft and a Code F wide-bodied freighter. Designed to transport heavy and oversized cargo, the An-124 is distinguished by its unique front-loading capability, with its nose opening to facilitate the loading of large consignments. Arriving from Abu Dhabi with approximately 46 tonnes of cargo, the aircraft’s visit demonstrates the NMIA’s ability to accommodate large, specialised freighter aircraft and support complex cargo operations.

GLOBAL **BYTES.**

APM Terminals builds big in Bangladesh

APM Terminals marked the official groundbreaking for APM Terminals Laldia, in Chattogram, as one of the largest public-private partnership investments in Bangladesh’s history as it moves from the signing to the construction stage. The \$550-million project is the flagship outcome of a government-to-government partnership that Bangladesh forged with Denmark to modernise its critical trade infrastructure. APM Terminals Laldia will be fully designed, financed, built and operated by APM Terminals and its partners in a first-of-its-kind model for Bangladesh’s port sector. Crucially, the port asset remains with Bangladesh even as it reaps the benefits of world-class private investment and operational expertise.



Surge in global container fleet capacity

“When the world’s shipyards deliver just a few more container ships, the global fleet capacity will for the first time reach 34 million twenty-foot equivalent units (TEU). At that time, the fleet will have grown by 10 million TEU — or 42 per cent — in just five-and-a-half years,” says Niels Rasmussen, Chief Shipping Analyst, BIMCO. To compare, earlier it took more than ten-and-a-half years to add 10 million TEU to increase fleet capacity to 24 million TEU, said BIMCO. At the beginning of September, global container fleet capacity was just 8,000 TEU below the 34-million-TEU mark. The milestone will, therefore, be reached after only a few of the 46 ships (totalling 2,86,000 TEU), scheduled for September delivery, enter into service.



Demand grows for air cargo services

The International Air Transport Association’s data for July global air cargo markets shows that demand grew nearly 4 per cent year-on-year. While all regions recorded growth, airlines in the Asia-Pacific, Europe and North America accounted for more than 90 per cent of the increase. Dedicated freighters gained market share as belly-hold traffic declined, possibly reflecting demand for larger or specialist shipments and the operational flexibility freighters can provide. Looking ahead, the outlook remains broadly positive, supported by manufacturing activity, export orders and global trade. However, higher fuel prices, geopolitical tensions and tariff uncertainty need to be watched carefully, said Marie Owens Thomsen, IATA’s Senior Vice-President, Sustainability, and Chief Economist.



RE **POSTS.**

- ✕ International passengers can now present their e-boarding passes during immigration clearance. Effective 1 September 2026, physical stamping of boarding passes is no longer required as the process moves towards a digital and paperless experience.
Chennai (MAA) Airport
@aachnairport
- ✕ Save 1033, the toll-free helpline on National Highways, for support during emergency and non-emergency situations. Whether it is a breakdown, accident, medical need or general assistance, one call connects you to immediate help. Keep 1033 handy and travel with greater confidence on every journey.
MORTHINDIA
@MORTHIndia

Truck rental rates

Rentals for 18-tonne payload

Truck route	Rentals as on		% change
	Aug 20	Sep 3	
Delhi-Mumbai-Delhi	1,76,000	1,75,000	-0.57
Delhi-Nagpur-Delhi	1,62,000	1,63,000	0.61
Delhi-Kolkata-Delhi	1,79,000	1,82,000	1.65
Delhi-Guwahati-Delhi	1,97,000	1,96,000	-0.51
Delhi-Hyderabad-Delhi	2,04,000	2,05,000	0.49
Delhi-Chennai-Delhi	2,20,000	2,20,000	0.00
Delhi-Bengaluru-Delhi	2,26,000	2,29,000	1.31
Delhi-Ranchi-Delhi	1,72,000	1,75,000	1.71
Delhi-Raipur-Delhi	1,68,000	1,68,000	0.00
Delhi-Kandla-Delhi	1,44,000	1,46,000	1.37
Mumbai-Chennai-Mumbai	1,75,000	1,75,000	0.00
Ludhiana-Hyderabad-Ludhiana	2,04,000	2,05,000	0.49
Mumbai-Kolkata-Mumbai	2,05,000	2,07,000	0.97
Chennai-Ahmedabad-Chennai	2,14,000	2,16,000	0.93
Bengaluru-Kolkata-Bengaluru	2,15,000	2,18,000	1.38
Bengaluru-Mumbai-Bengaluru	1,49,000	1,50,000	0.67
Delhi-Thiruvananthapuram-Delhi	2,85,000	2,88,000	1.04
Guwahati-Mumbai-Guwahati	2,85,000	2,87,000	0.70
Nagpur-Chennai-Nagpur	1,67,000	1,71,000	2.34
Kolkata-Guwahati-Kolkata	1,61,000	1,63,000	1.23
Indore-Delhi-Indore	1,48,000	1,52,000	2.63
Ahmedabad-Indore-Ahmedabad	1,05,000	1,05,000	0.00
Vijayawada-Mumbai-Vijayawada	1,65,000	1,68,000	1.79
Vijayawada-Kolkata-Vijayawada	1,56,000	1,57,000	0.64
Mumbai-Nagpur-Mumbai	1,17,000	1,20,000	2.50
Mumbai-Pune-Mumbai	72,000	75,000	4.00
Mumbai-Aurangabad-Mumbai	85,000	88,000	3.41
Mumbai-Nashik-Mumbai	70,000	74,000	5.41

Figures in ₹ Source: Subham Freight Carriers India Pvt Ltd

● **PEAK FREIGHT**

Logistics firms brace for festival runs

SEASON OF JOY. Delivery speed and scale are in focus as the festival shopping window stretches over several months

T E Raja Simhan

Beginning with Onam in August and up to Pongal in January, India’s festival calendar is turning into an extended peak season for the logistics industry, with the e-commerce, organised retail, consumer electronics, fashion and consumer durables segments expected to push cargo and express volumes higher.

What’s different this year is not merely the quantum of demand. Today’s customers increasingly expect deliveries marked by speed, flexibility and visibility, even as the festival shopping window stretches over several months and reaches deeper into tier-2 and tier-3 cities.

For logistics companies, this means shedding the traditional response of adding trucks, aircraft capacity, manpower and warehouses during peak season in favour of a more technology-driven model — one built around predicting emerging pressure points and moving capacity before bottlenecks develop. This includes distributed fulfilment, multimodal networks and flexible capacity.

The festival season is becoming a test of not just how much freight India’s logistics networks can carry, but also how intelligently they can respond to changing demand, say company officials.

A spokesperson of Flipkart said the e-commerce company’s supply chain and logistics subsidiary Ekart handles more than 3 billion packages annually, most of it related to festival season shopping, including its ‘Big Billion Days’ sales. As volumes scale up, Ekart’s infrastructure can handle up to 10 times the normal volume during peak periods.

In step with rising expectations, Flipkart offers same-day and next-day delivery in 250 cities, supported by Ekart’s nationwide logistics network. At the same time, the emergence of quick commerce is adding another layer to the festive rush, with nearly 1,050 micro-fulfilment centres across 130-plus cities active on its Minutes platform.

A LONGER, BROADER PEAK

Since the festival season runs from August to January, the cargo flow is more sustained rather than occurring in short, sharp spikes around individual shopping events.

Blue Dart expects to see increased movement of apparel and fashion accessories, consumer electronics and mo-



CELEBRATION TIME. Digital commerce has spread the express delivery demand beyond metros into tier-2 and -3 markets istock

bile devices, helped by festival sales promotions, product launches and growth in online shopping.

“We anticipate a healthy increase in cargo movement during the festive period, driven by sustained consumer demand and strong momentum across the e-commerce and retail sectors,” said Vikram Mansukhani, Chief of Operations, Blue Dart.

The delivery service company is also seeing demand from D2C brands and marketplaces that need agile logistics networks during seasonal peaks.

“Our focus during the festival season this year is on enhancing network agility, operational efficiency and customer experience. We continue to strengthen our forecasting and capacity planning capabilities through data-driven insights and predictive analytics, enabling us to respond more effectively to volume fluctuations. We are also augmenting processing capabilities at select locations and leveraging our integrated air and ground network to deliver greater speed and reliability,” Mansukhani said.

Vijay Kumar, CEO, Express Industry Council of India (EICI), said that while the festival season remains one of the busiest periods for the express delivery industry, digital commerce is expanding

beyond major metros into tier-2 and tier-3 markets, bringing more customers into the express delivery ecosystem.

BUILDING CAPACITY

Logistics companies began preparations months before the first major festival orders were placed.

Abhishek Chakraborty, CEO, DTDC Express Ltd, said the company expects substantially higher festival cargo movement this year, with Onam volumes already clocking nearly 30 per cent more than the monthly average. The impact was even greater in international deliveries, with revenue during the Onam month nearly twice the monthly average. “We expect demand to remain elevated during the festival cycle, until January,” he said.

The company has strengthened its network capacity by adding new facilities, transit hubs and processing infrastructure along key demand corridors. It is using data-led planning to deploy manpower, vehicles and processing capacity according to anticipated volumes, he said.

DTDC is also optimising movement along high-density corridors and using technology to improve shipment visibility and load planning. Its network of 16,500-plus customer access points, along with its hubs and branches,

provides the company with the scale and flexibility needed to respond as volumes build, he said.

One interesting initiative by DTDC is its Vallam Express in Kerala, which takes last-mile delivery onto waterways to reach communities that have limited road connectivity. The service is expected to facilitate more than 5,000 deliveries during the year, Chakraborty said.

FreightFox foresees about 40 per cent higher festival season demand compared with last year, according to Nitish Rai, Founder and CEO. “The festive season is typically the period when our business is busiest, with demand from the FMCG, retail and consumer durables sectors all rising together,” Rai said.

He added that some highway routes become congested much faster than others, and that problems could emerge on the quieter routes before becoming visible in broader network-level numbers. For logistics operators, identifying these pressure points early is becoming as important as forecasting the overall peak.

“The supply chain is, at present, not completely ready to meet this degree of demand,” Rai said, pointing to the need for improvements in visibility, planning, transporter networks and decision-making when routes become crowded.

● **VERTICAL INTEGRATION**

Regulating for infra equity



JAGANNARAYAN PADMANABHAN

There is a curious asymmetry in the way we regulate transport infrastructure.

In container shipping, it is increasingly common, and widely accepted, for an ocean carrier to own a stake in the terminal where its ships berth. MSC owns and operates terminals through Terminal Investment Limited (TiL); Maersk has APM Terminals; CMA CGM has built a substantial global terminal portfolio; and Hapag-Lloyd has established Hanseatic Global Terminals across various hub-and-spoke locations.

The situation is no different in India. Recent examples include Hapag-Lloyd acquiring 40 per cent stake in JM Baxi Ports & Logistics; CMA CGM in partnership in Nhava Sheva Free Port Terminal; and MSC’s Terminal Investment agreement to acquire 49 per cent stake in Vizhinjam terminal, operated by Adani Ports.

The logic is straightforward. A shipping line investing in a terminal can bring capital, technology, cargo and operational expertise. It can align vessel schedules with terminal operations, improve asset utilisation, create transshipment hubs and provide greater

certainty of capacity. However, there is a potential downside.

A carrier-controlled terminal could favour its own vessels, provide preferential berthing or pricing or disadvantage competing shipping lines. These concerns need to be addressed through concession conditions, competition law, transparent tariffs and non-discriminatory access requirements.

The recent debate over whether airport operators should be allowed to own airlines has brought into focus a much larger policy issue: How should India regulate vertical integration across the transport sector?

Concerns over airport ownership by airlines are understandable. Airports control scarce resources, such as slots, gates, parking stands and passenger facilities. An airport operator with interests in an airline could potentially favour it, disadvantaging competitors. Equally, a dominant airline controlling an airport could influence access to critical infrastructure.

This raises the question why such ownership structures, viewed as a potential problem in aviation, are accepted in maritime transport.

PROS AND CONS

The potential for conflicts of interest exists in ports too, yet vertical integration between shipping

lines and terminals is generally permitted. This warrants closer examination.

According to media reports, the Ministry of Civil Aviation has clarified that India does not have a blanket prohibition on airport operators owning or operating airlines. Restrictions largely arise from the concession agreements of individual public-private partnership airports. Notably, Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru and Hyderabad airports — which together account for nearly 80 per cent of India’s passenger traffic — contain such restrictions.

Vertical integration can generate significant benefits, including improved coordination across the value chain, economies of scale, growth in investment and operational efficiencies. At the same time, it can potentially lead to market foreclosure and concentration of market power.

Several developed economies follow vertical integration, where airlines operate dedicated terminals within airports, while competitive neutrality is maintained through regulatory oversight rather than outright ownership prohibitions.

In India, while policymakers aspire to create an integrated multimodal logistics system, regulation remains organised around individual modes.

As the country enters an era of unprecedented investment in transport and logistics infrastructure, questions remain over how vertical integration may improve efficiency and how it may harm competition. The apparent solution is to allow integration where it creates value, regulate where it creates market power, and ensure competition through transparent and consistent regulations.

After all, what’s good for the goose should not automatically be bad for the gander.

The writer is Senior Director and Global Head – Consulting, Crisil Ltd

We value your feedback. Do send your comments to **bl.logistics@thehindu.co.in**

● **SOARING BEYOND HYDERABAD**

Telangana eyes growth led by regional airports



WAITING FOR TAKE-OFF. Mamnoon in Warangal

G Naga Sridhar

Telangana’s aviation map appears set for a significant expansion, with Bhadradi Kothagudem, Warangal and Adilabad in focus for the State’s push to take air connectivity beyond capital Hyderabad.

For a largely land-locked State — with investment, employment and high-value economic activity traditionally concentrated in and around Hyderabad — the airport projects could provide the missing air link in developing stronger regional economic centres.

The State government has taken up the regional airports issue with Union Civil Aviation Minister K Rammo-han Naidu on several occasions, including during Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy’s recent visit to the Capital.

For the Bhadradi Kothagudem airport proposal, a Central technical team will arrive this month to inspect four or five shortlisted sites.

The Bhadradi Kothagudem region is home to the Sri Sitaramachandra Swamy temple, in Bhadrachalam, a major pilgrim destination, apart from its renown as an industrial and natural resources base.

In Warangal, the CM sought the Centre’s intervention for the early execution of the airport project at Mamnoon. With land acquisition completed, tenders are being floated, targeting project completion by the end of 2028.

Beyond just a regional airport, Mamnoon is being pitched for development according to international standards, with integrated facilities for maintenance, repair and overhaul (MRO), air cargo and hangar services.

The historic town of Warangal is a trading hub for agribased and other industries, alongside a steadily developing services sector, including the Warangal IT Tower.

The proposed airport is expected to support the Kakatiya Mega Textile Park, Kazipet Coach Factory and other industrial activity, while serving as an important aviation gateway for northern Telangana.

“The proposed airport could, therefore, become part of a wider economic geography in which manufacturing, logistics and services need not necessarily gravitate towards Hyderabad simply because air connectivity is concentrated there,” a senior official of the Telangana Industries Department said.

At Adilabad, the CM requested the Defence Ministry to develop a civil airport alongside the proposed defence airport, and offered support for land acquisition.

MY FIVE.



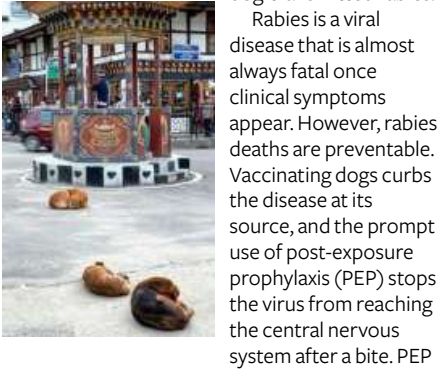
Fitness ring, daily walk, and balance of food

- 1 Movement: It's non-negotiable. Daily walking has become an important part of my routine. I consciously build movement into my workday through small changes like taking meetings while walking, standing during calls and avoiding prolonged periods of sitting.
- 2 Balance: It's always balance over restriction. I enjoy burgers, pizza, chaat and samosas, but focus on moderation. I balance indulgences with protein, vegetables and fibre, rather than cutting out the foods I enjoy.
- 3 Commit: Walking has been a gamechanger for me. By improving my daily habits and consistently walking 20,000-30,000 steps a day, I lost significant weight in just 3-4 months. Milind Soman and his commitment to lifelong fitness have been an inspiration.
- 4 Fitness ring: I try to make health a measurable part of my routine. I use my fitness ring to track movement, stress and recovery, which helps me understand when I need to take a break or get back to my routine. It keeps me accountable, even during demanding periods.
- 5 Consistent: I aim for at least 20 km of movement every day and find ways to stay active throughout the day. This helps avoid binge-eating. It's less about intense workouts and more about keeping movement consistent.

CAPSULE.

WHO validates Bhutan's rabies-free status

Bhutan is the first country in Southeast Asia to be validated by the World Health Organization (WHO) for eliminating dog-transmitted rabies.



Rabies is a viral disease that is almost always fatal once clinical symptoms appear. However, rabies deaths are preventable. Vaccinating dogs curbs the disease at its source, and the prompt use of post-exposure prophylaxis (PEP) stops the virus from reaching the central nervous system after a bite. PEP entails thorough wound washing, administration of a course of human rabies vaccine and, when indicated, rabies immunoglobulins (RIG) injection.

The WHO's goal is to end human deaths from dog-transmitted rabies by 2030, said Dr Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus, WHO Director-General, adding that Bhutan's success showed that the health of humans, animals and the environment was "inextricably" linked.

COMING UP.

Suicide prevention: Speak up

World Suicide Prevention Day (September 10) was established in 2003 by the International Association for Suicide Prevention, in partnership with the World Health Organization. 'Start the Conversation' is the call to action to mark the final year of the triennial (2024-26) theme 'Changing the Narrative on Suicide'. It calls on people to challenge harmful myths, reduce stigma and foster open, compassionate conversations about suicide. It also calls for prioritising suicide prevention and mental health in public policy.

● UNHEALTHY TREND

Patient safety in a time of fakes, misbrands and recalls

KEY ISSUES. Are fake drugs withdrawn on time, and is the regulatory system working as it should?

PT Jyothi Datta

August proved a troubling month for patient safety — with at least four separate reports related to fake medicines, voluntarily recalls and alleged misbranding.

An inter-State fake drugs network was busted after counterfeit blood pressure drug (Nicardia Retard) was seized in Gujarat by the Ahmedabad Crime Branch and State Food and Drugs Administration (FDA). The fakes were reportedly flagged by JB Chemicals after products carrying its branding but not made by it were found in the market.

In the second instance, the Drug Controller General of India flagged a fake rabies vaccine batch carrying the same branding and batch number as an Indian Immunological's vaccine. A search at a Delhi residence by the Crime Branch and drug inspectors found "rabies vaccine (Abhayrab); Batch No. KE25012... misbranded (not manufactured by Indian Immunologicals Ltd)", said a public notice from the regulator.

The third report was on the voluntary withdrawal of 11 eye drops by Sun Pharma as a "precautionary" measure. And the fourth was about the cancellation of Cipla's Pune warehouse licence, and its subsequent restoration by the Maharashtra FDA following a court directive, after Cipla contested the cancellation. It involved an ongoing case over alleged misbranding of Reactin Plus tablets, the State FDA said.

The frequency of these alleged violations poses critical questions on patient safety: Are fake or ineffective medicines withdrawn from the market before they are consumed by patients? Does the drug regulatory framework need tightening or are more cases being reported due to improved regulatory intervention?



The Health Ministry, for example, regularly releases reports of 'not of standard quality' (NSQ) medicines and spurious drugs (imitation products that may or may not have the active ingredient). The spurious drug alert, though, does not name the company or brand, except to say it is being investigated.

HEALTH THREAT

The July NSQ/spurious drug report, for example, mentions spurious buprenorphine injection IP 2ml, a painkiller. In the Ahmedabad case involving fake blood pressure medicines, media reports said 1,500 strips (of 10 tablets each) may have been sold to patients.

Dr Abhay Shukla, National Convener of Jan Swasthya Abhiyan, explained that medicines are prescribed to treat a particular condition. So if a medicine is NSQ, it could be "health-threatening", if not life-threatening. An ineffective NSQ blood pressure medicine could lead to a stroke or heart attack, he pointed out.

Dr HG Koshia, former Commissioner of the Gujarat Food and Drugs Control Administration, recollected that when he took charge (2009-10), about 95 per cent of recalled drugs had

been consumed before the companies began recalling them. The State regulator then put in place an SMS-based recall system to alert the supply chain, distributor, wholesaler and retail chemist, said Koshia, who retired in 2025.

WHO IS RESPONSIBLE?

Company representatives sometimes claim that they have visibility only up to the distributor and not the neighbourhood chemist. That is not a legitimate reason, said Koshia, since manufacturing licences are for selling quality medicines, and the onus is on them to produce medicine that retains quality until expiry.

If there is a recall for some reason, the companies must ensure the products come back to them, he said, adding that distributors have the supply data for the medicines. The Drugs and Cosmetics (D&C) Act mandates a bill or memo for every product sold, mentioning the product name, batch number, the names of purchaser and wholesaler, the quantity sold and the expiry date. This has been "the law of the land since 1945", he said.

Former Commissioner of Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration Mahesh Zagade said the

regulatory framework for medicines is adequate.

It is the Health Secretaries and drug regulators who have to implement the food and drugs statutes and act against those failing to do their job, he said.

Zagade had, as FDA chief, called for compensation for patients when J&J recalled hip implants. On product recalls, he said there are provisions to detail the drug supply chain down to the consumer "but they are on paper". Almost 100 per cent of recalled products get consumed, he alleged, with the reasons ranging from delays in sample testing to corrupt "money-making".

FIXING ACCOUNTABILITY

Manufacturers are mandated to test raw materials before using them and the finished product before releasing it in the market, Zagade said, a process that can ensure only quality products are available.

Parliamentarians also need to ensure that laws they help formulate are implemented in their constituencies. Otherwise they should raise it with the Central and State governments, he said, adding that this culture of holding people accountable would help protect customer rights.

● FROM THE REGULATOR

Data sharing on animal testing alternatives

The European Medicines Agency (EMA) has launched a new voluntary data submission (VDS) pilot to facilitate the sharing of data generated using New Approach Methodologies (NAMs). These innovative methods have the potential to provide information comparable to, or better than current testing approaches, while helping replace or reduce the use of traditional animal studies in the non-clinical development of medicines.

This pilot is part of the EMA's efforts to foster the regulatory acceptance of NAMs by enabling regulators to gain experience with these approaches and assess their scientific value. NAMs can include complex in vitro systems, such as organoids and microphysiological systems, computational models and a combination of multiple methodologies. Ultimately, the initiative aims to strengthen the future use of scientifically robust alternatives to animal testing in regulatory decision-making. It builds on the EMA's longstanding commitment to the 3Rs principles — replace, reduce and refine the use of animals in medicine development and regulation.

Although NAMs are increasingly used in research and early medicine development, data on their use is rarely shared with regulators, limiting the opportunities to build confidence in their regulatory application.

The new VDS pilot aims to create a structured, non-binding framework that enables companies, method developers, contract research organisations, academic laboratories and other stakeholders to voluntarily submit and discuss NAM data independent of a marketing authorisation application. Participants will receive individual, non-binding and non-decisional feedback from an operational expert group, comprising non-clinical experts from across the European medicines regulatory network.

The initiative aims to enhance scientific dialogue, increase regulatory experience with NAMs, promote harmonised assessment approaches across Europe and support the development of a sustainable framework for integrating these innovative methods into medicine regulation.

Organisations interested in participating in the new pilot can apply. Following an initial validation process, the selected applicants will be invited to submit a full briefing package for scientific assessment. Submissions to the VDS pilot are expected until the third quarter of 2027. At the end of the pilot, the EMA will publish a lessons-learned report.



ISTOCK

Source: EMA

LENS ON HEALTH



EMOTIONAL TOLL. A healthcare worker holds his colleague during a break from handling the bodies of victims who perished in the flash floods and mudslide at the Maithili Barrack in Trishuli, Nuwakot district, Nepal REUTERS

When 'the doctor is in' without a pause

BY INVITATION



KAVITA ARORA



ISTOCK

When does a doctor stop being a doctor? Is it when she leaves the hospital or when the phone is finally switched off? For many professionals, the role remains long after work formally ends. It inhabits the body as readiness, responsibility and vigilance.

Research on emotional labour helps explain why. Healthcare professionals continuously regulate their own emotions while responding to others' fears and expectations. The invisible burden is in not only witnessing suffering, but responding to it in real time, under conditions of uncertainty. The smartphone has only sharpened this. It has altered the architecture of care: The possibility of crisis now travels home in a pocket. Even when no call comes, anticipation itself becomes work. The doctor leaves the room, but a part of the room stays with her.

Over time, this readiness leaves a physiological signature. The literature on allostatic load suggests that sustained responsibility and chronic vigilance reshape physiological systems, compressing the natural rhythm between activation and recovery into prolonged readiness interrupted by brief moments of rest. The deepest changes are not simply the coping mechanisms. They become ways of being: Heightened attunement, expanded responsibility, moral reflection and difficulty receiving care for oneself. The work gradually becomes part of the self.

This inner life is hardly new. In her book *In a Better Place: A Doctor's Journey*, Bornali Datta reminds us that medicine is never only about disease — in her words, it is "a story of human lives caught in the cusp of aspiration and reality". The suffering of patients and the frailties of caregivers remain deeply intertwined.

And yet, the hidden curriculum of healthcare in India still rewards

endurance, composure and self-sacrifice. Vulnerability is welcomed in patients but often treated with caution in professionals. Silence about this, however, extracts its own cost, turning understandable distress into private burdens.

What keeps people going despite this? In years of conversations with friends in the field of medicine, I've come to believe that "meaning making" probably does. Colleagues, humour, supervision, art, spirituality and witnessing human courage provide continuity. Healing is never a one-directional act. Those who care for others are themselves changed by what they witness.

Where are the spaces that encourage healthcare professionals to speak as human beings? Across the world, reflective practice groups, Balint groups, supervision spaces, narrative medicine circles and communities of inquiry have emerged, not to solve suffering but to think over it.

Who hears the healers? For generations, healthcare professionals have learned to compartmentalise, and these boundaries do matter: Patients deserve spaces centred on their needs. Can professionalism also involve reflection, awareness and ethical self-understanding, not just separation?

These are not questions with easy answers. They are questions worth staying with. The future of compassionate healthcare may depend not only on how we care for patients but also whether we can acknowledge that healers, too, are changed by the work of healing.

The writer is a founding cohort member of India Mental Health Alliance, a child and adolescent psychiatrist, and Co-founder of Children First. Views are personal

Making the community integral to palliative care

How Kozhikode-based organisation pioneered affordable and sustainable care for patients with life-limiting illnesses

V Sajeew Kumar

In 1993, when K Suresh Kumar began advocating palliative care in Kerala, few knew about the concept, and organised services for patients with life-limiting illnesses were almost non-existent. What began as the work of a handful of individuals has since evolved into one of the world's most widely recognised community-based palliative care models.

Kumar founded the Kozhikode-based Institute of Palliative Medicine (IPM) to ensure that people could access palliative care regardless of their economic or social circumstances.

Today, in Kerala, palliative care reaches nearly 60 per cent of those in need, compared with less than 2 per cent nationally. The model has been replicated in several regions outside Kerala, and the IPM



END CARE. K Suresh Kumar, Founder, Institute of Palliative Medicine

conducts training programmes for participants from around 60 countries, including high-income countries like Japan and Singapore.

Kumar's contribution to making palliative care affordable, sustainable and community-driven recently earned him the prestigious WHO South-East Asia Regional

Award for Public Health Champions.

Globally, palliative care has traditionally been associated with hospitals, specialised institutions and trained medical professionals. Kerala gradually moved away from that model, taking care into homes and neighbourhoods, and making communities an integral part

of the care system, he says.

Two features distinguish Kerala's approach. The first is placing the primary responsibility for palliative care at the local government-level rather than leaving it entirely within the healthcare system. The second is recognising that ordinary members of the community can make an important contribution to caring for people with serious illnesses.

The State now has more than 1,750 palliative care units at the grassroots level. Around 1,100 are run by local self-government institutions, about 500 by civil society organisations, and nearly 150 by political parties, which is rather unique globally.

"I was formally trained in palliative care in the United Kingdom, within an institution-based model. Even then, it was clear that the models developed in high-income countries would not readily suit the realities of countries like India,

although the way forward was less clear," he says.

One of the biggest challenges Kumar faced was in convincing people that palliative care could not be confined to clinical medicine. Care for the seriously ill was traditionally regarded as the responsibility of doctors, nurses and hospitals. But patients living with chronic and life-limiting illnesses often require much more than medical intervention. They need help with daily activities, emotional support, social interaction and dignity at the end of life.

The biggest gaps today, he says, are in quality assurance, consistency and standardisation of services, and equitable coverage across different geographical areas. Addressing these shortcomings will require stronger policies, sustainable funding and systematic capacity building across both community-based and professional systems.

QUICKLY.

EOS-05 finishes orbit manoeuvre



Chennai: ISRO's Earth Observation Satellite EOS-05 has successfully completed significant orbit manoeuvres as it heads towards Earth's Geosynchronous Orbit. The satellite was injected into the geosynchronous transfer orbit (GTO) in the early hours of Friday (September 4) by the space agency's Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle. From the GTO, the satellite will use in-built propulsion systems to further ascend its way to higher orbits before reaching the intended GEO at a distance of 36,000 kilometers. Post Friday's launch, V Naryanan, Chairman, ISRO, said the satellite will take around 4-5 days to reach the GEO. Once there, EOS-05 will be India's first imaging satellite in the GEO, a significant milestone for the country's strategic surveillance capabilities. **OUR BUREAU**

OPEC+ keeps oil output policy unchanged for Oct

OPEC+ kept its oil output policy unchanged for October at a meeting on Sunday as the group needs to agree on new quotas before deciding its next output steps. The meeting of seven core OPEC+ members — Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, Kuwait, Algeria, Kazakhstan and Oman — comes as the Iran war continues to disrupt oil exports through the Strait of Hormuz. In August, OPEC+ agreed its production boost for September, completing a phased rollback of a 1.6 5million bpd supply cut first agreed in 2023. **REUTERS**

Upcoming BRICS Summit not likely to include bloc expansion on agenda

COMMON GROUND. Delhi wants to increase participation of new members, partner countries in specific areas

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



TAKING THE LEAD. India is seeking consensus on issues such as cross-border payments and economic cooperation

The BRICS Summit, to be hosted by India on September 12-13, is unlikely to consider further expansion of the grouping as there is no consensus among existing members on admitting more countries, officials said. "India is expected to use its chairship to focus on consolidating the grouping after its significant enlargement from five members to 11 over the past two years, and ensuring better integration of the new members and partner countries into its various mechanisms. There is no consensus yet on further expansion, so the matter isn't likely to be considered," an official tracking the matter told *businessline*. The enlarged grouping itself is grappling with the

more difficult task of arriving at common positions on geopolitical issues, especially the West Asia conflict. **DIFFERENCES CROP UP** Sharp differences between Iran and the UAE have made consensus more elusive, and are complicating efforts of arriving at an agreement on a joint communique for the New Delhi summit, sources said. At the BRICS Summit, India is seeking consensus on issues such as cross-border payments, economic cooperation and reform of multilateral institutions, the official added. The summit aims to strengthen cooperation on

trade, investment, finance, technology and development, while advancing the bloc's push for a greater voice for the Global South in global institutions. **EXPANSION PROCESS** During the 2024 expansion process, more than 30 countries expressed interest in joining BRICS, either as full members or partners during the 2024 expansion process. Türkiye, Azerbaijan, Pakistan and Bangladesh are among countries that have expressed interest in full membership, while countries, including Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand and Vietnam, have joined the partner-country framework. BRICS admission rules require consensus among existing members. The official noted that BRICS had evolved substantially over the past two decades, and required a lot of collaboration. "There are 35 tracks at the level of ministers and heads of agencies, which is a very, very elaborate programme for collaboration. It requires a lot of participation, engagement and effort," said the official. India has, therefore, sought to increase the participation of new members and partner countries in specific areas of cooperation. "We have made an effort this year to make sure that we encourage participation of new members and partner countries in certain sectors during our chairship," said the official. This is reflected in the proposed participation in the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, which includes not just leaders of BRICS members, but also all partner countries and a number of outreach invitees.

Reports of privatisation are incorrect, says ISRO

Our Bureau
Chennai

To quell internal anxieties about privatisation with its employees seeking a clarification, space body ISRO said on Sunday that reports of privatisation were "baseless and incorrect". "We wish to categorically state that ISRO will neither be privatised nor will its importance be diminished. ISRO will continue to remain India's principal institution for advanced space research and technology development, national and strategic missions, space science and exploration, and critical and frontier space capabilities," the marquee institution said in a statement. **ISRO'S ROLE** The organisation noted that increased private participation in space is not about reducing ISRO's role. "It is about enabling ISRO to focus even more strongly on the next generation of India's space programme, while industry scales up mature

technologies and capabilities," it said. The government initiated reforms in 2020 and institutionalised it through the Indian Space Policy 2023, along with progressive liberalisation of FDI policy in the sector. The reforms should, therefore, be seen as "ecosystem expansion and capability multiplication, not privatisation", said ISRO.

HOW IT BEGAN The controversy began from recent public remarks made by Pawan Kumar Goenka, Chairperson of the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe), that eventually ISRO will not make any launch vehicles, and that these would be done by the private sector. Following this, employee associations wrote to ISRO Chairman V Narayanan demanding urgent clarification. Employees, worried that ISRO will be diminished, sought clarifications regarding their employment and other concerns.

Assocham urges govt to take up visa, permanent magnets issue with China

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

As the stage gets set for the BRICS Summit on September 12-13, industry body Assocham has written to Rudendra Tandon, Secretary, Ministry of External Affairs, proposing a structured inter-ministerial engagement with the Ambassador of the People's Republic of China on residual visa, technology movement and supply chain matters affecting manufacturing here. According to sources, visa curbs on Indians from various sectors, including automotive and electronics, over

the last two years, along with restrictions on materials such as rare earth permanent magnets (REPM), had led to a disruption in manufacturing, prompting calls for a quick resolution to safeguard the supply chain. "The industry is, at present, scaling up capacity under Atmanirbhar Bharat in electric mobility, cell manufacturing, electronics and capital goods. In each of these areas, timely access to specialised equipment, technical personnel and certain critical inputs has become a key determinant of project schedules and unit costs. China continues to be a significant source in all of them," sources quoting the letter told *businessline*. **CRITICAL INPUTS** Industry sources also said that while there are no individual meetings lined up between the Chinese delegates and Indian auto industry, the high-level talks would include timely access to specialised equipment, technical personnel and certain critical inputs. More than 200 businessmen from China are set to arrive in India as part of the Chinese delegation. **BUILDING TIES** They will explore opportunities in various areas and

considerable assistance to Indian manufacturers in meeting their commissioning schedules and in competing in global markets," the letter said. The industry body mentioned that commissioning and installing an imported plant ordinarily requires the presence of the supplier's engineers for defined periods and, thereafter, for warranty support. Assocham members have reported difficulty in securing the deployment of such personnel in time, with consequent slippage in project schedules. **CERTAIN CATEGORIES** Also, licensing requirements

applicable to REPM to certain specialised materials and specified categories of equipment have introduced an element of uncertainty into procurement planning. The difficulty lies in the timing and predictability of licensing decisions, rather than in the existence of the regime itself, it said. "Members report delay in obtaining business visas for Indian executives and engineers travelling to China for supplier audits, factory acceptance testing and technical training. Reciprocity in this regard would assist industry on both sides. Shipments against concluded contracts are, on occasion, interrupted for reasons that appear to be administrative rather than commercial. Projects working to fixed commissioning dates find such interruptions particularly difficult to absorb," it added. Therefore, Assocham urged the government on giving permanence to the recent visa facilitation measures with indicative service timelines published, multiple entry business visas of suitable validity for technical personnel engaged in assignments that extend over several visits, and alignment of visa validity with equipment commissioning and warranty schedules.

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